A-A-53535
27 June 1988

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

STAPLER, SKIN, SURGICAL (Disposable)

The General Services Administration has approved the use of this commercial item description.

This commercial item description covers four disposable skin staplers used to close surgical incisions.

Salient characteristics:

General. Shall be disposable, hand-held, surgical skin staplers designed for "one-handed" operation (See Note 1). Each stapler covered by this document shall be pre-loaded with skin staples. The size and quantity of staples loaded in each stapler shall be as specified herein (See Note 3). Staples shall be supplied in two sizes Regular and Wide. Dimensions of both skin staple sizes shall be as specified below.

Table I.

Dimensions of skin staples

SIZE	DIMENSIONS *
"Regular"	5.7 mm Crown width 3.9 mm Leg length
"Wide"	6.9 mm Crown width 3.9 mm Leg length

*NOTE - Tolerance on all staple dimensions shall be ± 10%.

Performance. Each stapler covered by this document shall drive and clinch a skin staple into living tissue when the user follows the instructions provided with the stapler. (See "Instructions"). The force needed to fire a single staple into living tissue shall be 5.5 ± 2.5 pounds.

AMSC N/A FSC 6515

DISTRIBUTION STATEMENT A. Approved for public release; distribution is unlimited.

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Materials. Staplers shall be fabricated from rigid plastic and corrosion-resisting steel. The modulus of elasticity of "rigid" plastic shall be not less than 100,000 psi when tested in accordance with ASTM Designation D638. Testing of "rigid" plastic shall be conducted at 23 degrees C (73 degrees F) and 50% relative humidity. Corrosion resisting steel shall meet all requirements of ASTM Designation F899.

Skin staples shall be fabricated from corrosion-resisting steel wire that complies with ASTM Designation F55, Grade 1 or Grade 2.

All materials shall be suitable for their intended purpose.

Sterility. The stapler shall be sterile in accordance with the latest edition of the United States Pharmacopeia (USP).

Instructions. Each package of skin staplers shall be supplied with a "Directions for Use" manual.

Workmanship. Each stapler covered by this document shall be free from defects that detract from its appearance or impair its serviceability.

Unit. Package (PG). One package containing six individually packaged sterile skin staplers of one size only, with instructions for use, as specified, constitutes one unit. The individual package shall be a sealed, peel open type container capable of maintaining sterility of contents unless package is damaged or opened.

Quality Assurance Provisions.

Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

Records. Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government upon the Government's request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and for a period of three years after delivery of the supplies to which such records relate.

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Inspection. Inspection, as used herein, is defined as both examination (such as visual or auditory investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances or procedures) and testing (determination by technical means of physical and chemical properties of the item.

Tests. Tests shall be conducted to determine compliance with specification requirements. Where feasible, the same sample shall be used for the determination of two or more test characteristics.

Sampling for inspection. Sampling for inspection of the end item shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105 at Level S-2, AQL 0.65%. The unit of product for inspection purposes shall be one skin stapler.

Contractor certification. The contractor shall certify that the product offered meets the salient characteristics of this description and conforms to the producers' own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

Metric products. Products manufactured to metric dimensions will be considered on an equal basis with those manufactured using inch-pound units, providing they fall within the tolerances specified using conversion tables contained in the latest revision of Federal Standard No. 376, and all other requirements of this document are met.

If a product is manufactured to metric dimensions and those dimensions exceed the tolerances specified in the inch/pound units, a request should be made to the contracting officer to determine if the product is acceptable.

The contracting officer has the option of accepting or rejecting the product.

Regulatory requirements.

Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act. If the product covered by this document has been determined by the U.S. Food and Drug Administration to be under its jurisdiction, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of the Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act, as amended, and regulations promulgated thereunder. In addition, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of all other applicable Federal, State, and local statutes, ordinances, and regulations.

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Recovered materials. The offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered material in accordance with Public Law 94-580 to the maximum extent practical.

Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking. Unless otherwise specified, preservation, packaging, and packing shall be to a degree of protection to preclude damage to contents thereof under normal shipping conditions, handling, etc., involving shipment from the supply source to the receiving activity, plus reshipment from receiving activity, and shall conform to applicable carrier's rules and regulations. Intermediate and exterior package quantities and labeling and marking shall be as specified in the contract and/or order.

NOTE 1: An example of a skin stapler designed for "one-handed" operator is given in Figure 1.

NOTE 2: This document covers the following National Stock Numbers:

NSN	ITEM IDENTIFICATION
6515-01-071-5561	STAPLER, SKIN, SURGICAL, Disposable, 35 Size 6.9 by 3.9 mm Staples, 6s.
6515-01-076-4647	STAPLER, SKIN, SURGICAL, Disposable, with 30 to 35 Size 5.7 by 3.9 mm Staples, 6s.
6515-01-110-4797	STAPLER, SKIN, SURGICAL, Disposable, 15 Size 6.9 by 3.9 mm Staples, 6s.
6515-01-162-1957	STAPLER, SKIN, SURGICAL, Disposable, 15 Size 5.7 by 3.9 mm Staples, 6s

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NOTE 3: The staple charge for each item covered by this document is as follows:

NSN	STAPLE CHARGE	STAPLE SIZE
6515-01-071-5561	30-35 Staples	Wide Size
6515-01-076-4647	30-35 Staples	Regular Size
6515-01-110-4797	12-20 Staples	Wide Size
6515-01-107-1957	12-20 Staples	Regular Size

Ordering data (Intermediate/exterior package quantities and labeling and marking must be specified in the contract and/or order).

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Custodians:

Army - MD
Navy - MS
Air Force - 03

Preparing Activity:

DoD-MD

Agent:

DLA-DM

CIVIL COORDINATING ACTIVITIES:

VA-CSS
PHS
FDA-MPQAS

PGC SF030

Project No. 6515-4084

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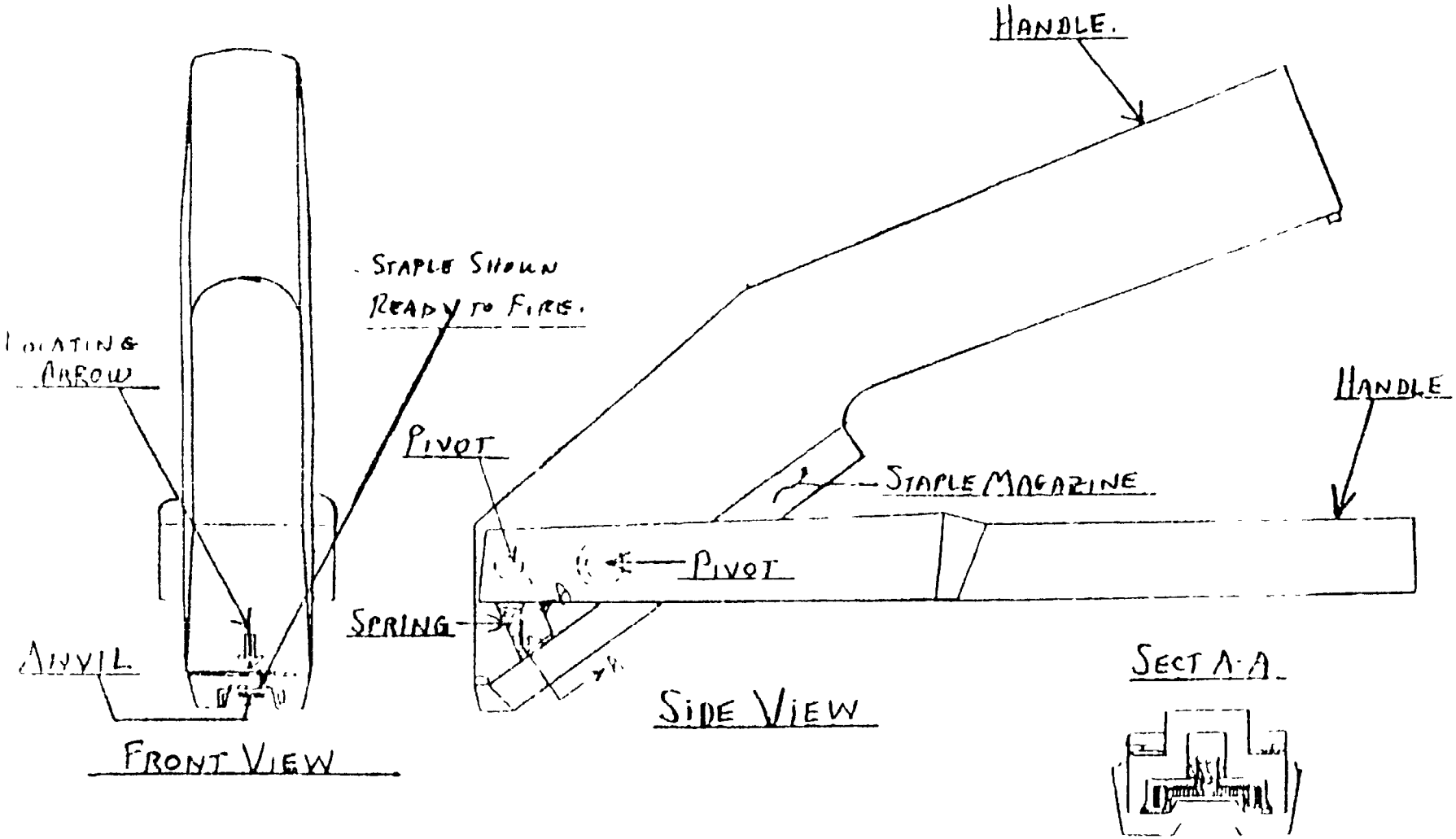


FIGURE 1

STAPLER, SKIN, SURGICAL, DISPOSABLE

(Note: Example Only !)

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NOTE: This form may not be used to request copies of documents, nor to request waivers, deviations, or clarification of specification requirements on current contracts. Comments submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document(s) or to amend contractual requirements.

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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

(See Instructions – Reverse Side)

1. DOCUMENT NUMBER
A-A-53535

2. DOCUMENT TITLE
STAPLER, SKIN, Surgical (Disposable

3a. NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION

4. TYPE OF ORGANIZATION *(Mark one)*

- ☐ VENDOR
- ☐ USER
- ☐ MANUFACTURER
- ☐ OTHER *(Specify)*

3b. ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)*

5. PROBLEM AREAS

a. Paragraph Number and Wording

b. Recommended Wording

c. Reason/Rationale for Recommendation

6. REMARKS

7a. NAME OF SUBMITTER *(Last, First, MI)* – Optional

7b. WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER *(Include Area Code)* – Optional

7c. MAILING ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)* – Optional

8. DATE OF SUBMISSION *(YYMMDD)*

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